

individuals. Be it for work, school or any other venture, the applications in your office software suites are extremely crucial since you're likely to use them day in and day out. To give you a gist, even this article is being typed out on word processing software. Among a few possible uses of office software are its ability to draft a letter, make a presentation, write a report or create a budget. Considering that the software is employed not only by offices, but also by schools, families and individuals – the name, Office Suite is somewhat a misnomer, and hence the term 'Productivity Suite' might be more apt to describe such a software package.

So which software would you find in a typical office suite? Though the features could differ in each suite, (almost) every credible productivity suite includes some basic applications. Other applications, though not a staple of every suite, are still important inclusions in many available office suites. Basic applications include:

- Word processing software
- Spreadsheet building software
- Presentation creating software

Other applications include:

- Database manager
- Email client
- Publishing platform
- Project management software
- Collaboration software

We'll cover the important features and details of some of these applications in the next chapter. As a primer, let us explain just the basics of what each application does.

Word processing software

'Word processing' is the act of typing, editing and printing textual/graphical information using a word processor. In the olden days, this was done mechanically using a typewriter. Typewriters are now slowly becoming extinct, and almost everyone does word processing electronically through their computers. The biggest advantage of this shift is the quick and easy creation of error-free documents thanks to the rewrite option, conspicuous by its absence in mechanical word processors. Sometimes abbreviated as WP, a word processor is capable of creating, storing and printing documents that can be saved for modification later and accessed from any other computer using the same word processor. A word processor shouldn't be